

3. Interception, protection or appropriation of valuable, useful, scandalous, embarrassing and discrediting information

Issues arising

Governments now have the ability to monitor citizens like never before with the introduction of programmes such as the total information awareness programme in the US and laws such as the Communications Assistance For Law Enforcement Act—a wiretapping law in the US. Governments are aided further by analysis, dissemination, visualisation, insight and semantic enhancement technologies such as high-speed surveillance computers and biometric software.

It is necessary to find the balance between surveillance requirements and the privacy of those affected by surveillance. Many civil rights and privacy groups such as the Electronic Frontier Foundation and ACLU feel that continuous surveillance of citizens by the government will lead to a society with little or no political and personal freedom. Hence there is a need for ensuring judicious use of electronic surveillance.

Systems available

Security and surveillance systems help protect malls, banks, homes, shops, offices, institutions, commercial complexes, etc. Security evaluations generally include threat and vulnerability analysis, risk assessment, facility improvement recommendations and detailed security assessment.

Use of mobiles is the latest in security systems. These allow remote video surveillance over 3G, a variety of alerts based on SMS, MMS, sound and light, automatic video storage and a host of other facilities



Video surveillance systems

Electronic security gadgets are quite expensive, which is why most people do not use them in their homes.

Electronic security and surveillance systems include access control systems, CCTV and IP surveillance systems, biometric systems, guard tour systems, perimeters fencing systems, intrusion detection systems, car parking systems, fire alarm and detection systems, visitor management systems, GPS-/GPRS-based vehicle tracking systems and guard monitoring systems.

One of the big trends in electronic surveillance is security convergence. Wikipedia defines security convergence as the convergence of two historically distinct security functions—physical security and information security—within enterprises. Integrated security systems enable facility managers to efficiently and intelligently handle any event or incident, addressing the risks of safety, security and operations at the same time and place.

Integrated electronic security system services include:

1. Enterprise-wide multi-server integrated electronic security implementations
2. Scalable deployments from local and single site to nationwide and multi-site capabilities
3. Consulting services and project

management

4. Fibre-optics
5. Network video recording
6. Digital video recording
7. Video-over-Internet protocol (VoIP)
8. Integrated closed-circuit television (CCTV)
9. Wireless solutions

Use of mobiles is the latest in security systems. Be it your children alone at home, ailing parents in hospital or securing the home from burglars, mobile phones give you live feed anytime, anywhere. These allow remote video surveillance over 3G, a variety of alerts based on SMS, MMS, sound and light, automatic video storage and a host of other facilities.

Looking forward

Despite the advancements in electronic surveillance and security systems, traditional physical security measures such as mechanical locks and guards continue to play a major role. The security needs vary for every person, community and organisation. Integrated security is the best possible way to efficiently manage any crisis. Rise of integrated security will lead to revision of security policies. ●

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